

# KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 20

--"MINI-MEETNG" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULLNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

## BIBLE TEACHING

KF Confession 5 describes the path of wasted energy and lost potential. Let's hear it again:

We attacked and cruelly suppressed our True Self and lost our True Life.

Let's look at **Psalm 23:1-4**. Nancy has retranslated these verses using some of the KF vocabulary that is now familiar to us.

<sup>1</sup>The Lord is my Shepherd,

I have everything that I need today.

<sup>2</sup>He makes me lie down satisfied in green pastures;

He leads me beside quiet waters.

<sup>3</sup>For His own reputation and for my reputation as His creature,

He restores and repairs my True Self.

<sup>4</sup>He guides me in the tracks of orientation even though

I walk through the valley of the shadow of death.

I fear no harm, for You are with me.

The guidance and training of Your rod and staff comfort me.

Take a deep breath.

### 1. Our Shepherd is the Lord, not our Idol Self

The relationship with the Shepherd is not a legal contract based on shoulds, claims, and punishments. It is based on the trust and the trustworthiness developed in a karis relationship. The Shepherd responds to what you reveal about yourself and takes into consideration your unique personhood as He guides you. He is the one who trains you for your joy and for your mission.

### 2. I have everything that I need for today

With Jesus as our Shepherd, and not the Idol Self, we can gradually let go of fighting for our idealized life, fleeing self-hate, and trying to get our compulsive needs met. As we spend time doing things His way, we begin to experience satisfaction and contentment.

One of the things that we need when we are in self-hate is a quiet, safe place. When you are with someone who is suffering from self-hate, Nancy's advice is this: *No sudden movements. No loud noises. (Repeat)* In other words, be compassionate around those in self-hate, including yourself—and be very careful.

**3. He restores my True Self, not my Idol Self**

We need to calm down, follow the Shepherd's leading, and find rest in order to recover our lost True Self. The Hebrew word for *restore* can be translated as *turning back*. It also carries the meaning of *repair*. Does your soul need repair? The soul that Jesus died for and repairs is our True Self, not the Idol Self. Sometimes we feel very disappointed about that.

**4. He guides me in the tracks of orientation for His name's sake**

If we call ourselves Christians, we bear the name of Jesus, and we are responsible for His reputation. As oriented people, we are the representatives of His name in this messed-up world. Sometimes we get caught up in orienting to, and even representing, a way of thinking or an organization. That is not our real business. Our business is to be oriented to God and to represent His kingdom.

**5. The tracks of orientation lead into the valley of the shadow of death**

To our dismay, the tracks of orientation always lead into the valley of the shadow of death. It will feel like death to give up old patterns and behaviors that you have habitually used to save your Idol's life. We are in Karis Fellowships because we want a different life, but in order to gain that different life, we have to lose the Idol's life. The fear of death is only a shadow for Christians. It is the darkness that we enter when we dare to resist the Idol Self and its pride. The fear of death is real, but it passes like a cloud passing over the sun. It only has the power of a shadow.

**6. His rod and staff comfort me**

The rod and staff are instruments of training—the *dos* and *don'ts* of the Bible. They replace the shoulds and claims of your own legal systems. When you commit to doing things God's way, you have to stop doing things your way. That feels like losing your life. But when you want to abandon this difficult process of training, the promise of God's presence and His faithful provision can keep you going. You can trust the rod and staff in the Shepherd's hands as He trains you for your potential.

Psalm 23 encourages us to grow in our courage while we confront the problem of our pride, self-hate, and judgments. With God's support, we can journey through any problem.

Our prayer might go something like this:

*Shepherd, strengthen my courage and endurance for the valley. (Repeat)*

Take a deep breath.

**ENDING PRAYER**

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for the gift of healing and training together. Help us find courage in Your promises as You guide us to access Your provision. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to pass through the valley of death so that we can flourish in our connection with our True Self and design, with the Creation and the community, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.